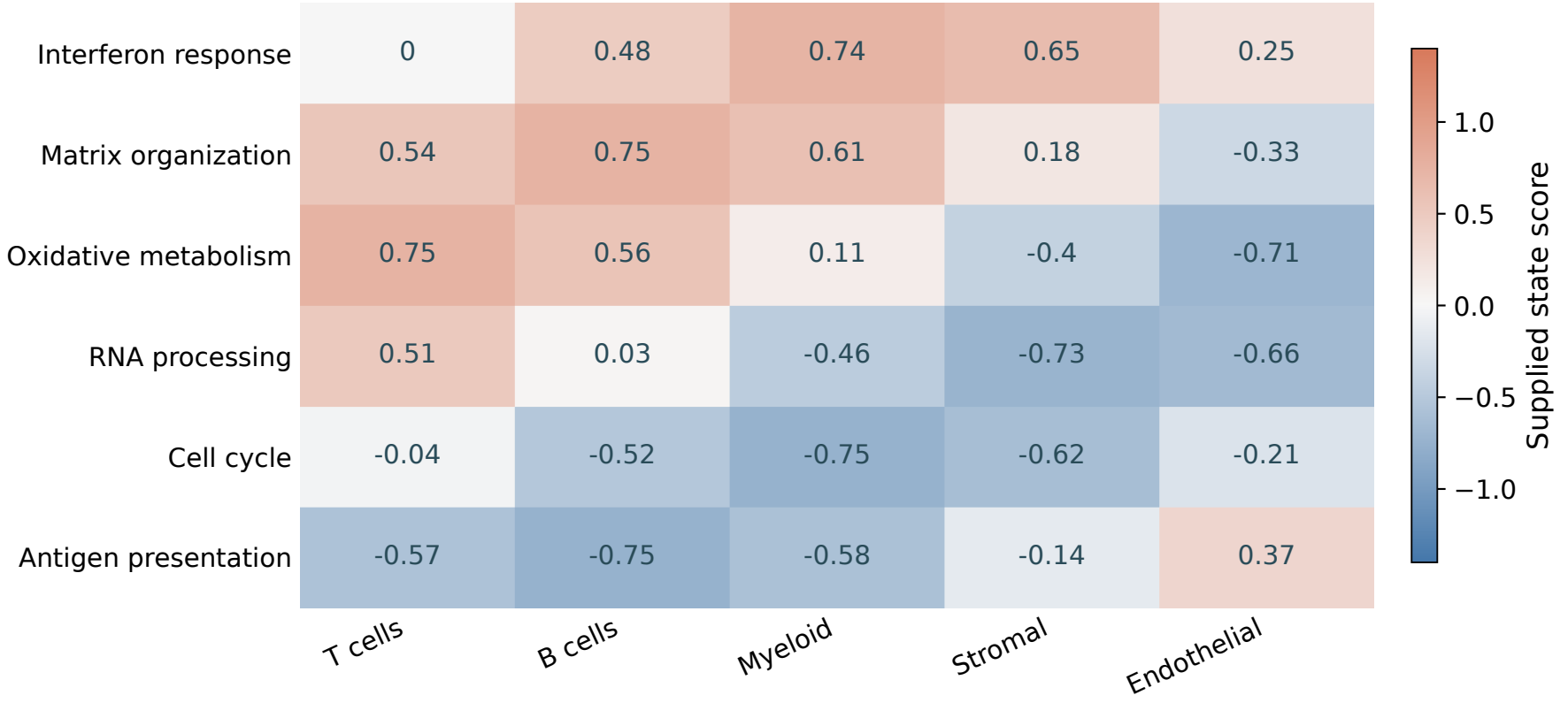State, stress and cycle contexts